



Cub Debuts in Tigerland

DELHI The only available photograph of Charles Anthony Prabhakaran shows him as a cherubic youth in jeans and sneakers with his mother Mathivadhani and a battle fatigues-clad father Prabhakaran and his younger sister Dhuwaraha. The decade-old picture a rare photo-op of the LTTE's first family in the Wanni jungles.

In the first confirmation that he's joined the family business, LTTE's military spokesperson Rasaih Ilanthirayan told INDIA TODAY from the Tiger's Wanni stronghold, "He's been inducted into

the organisation and he is doing well. I am not authorised to give you any details."

Lankan sources filled in the details. The 22-year-old Anthony—named after one of Prabhakaran's closest associates killed in 1983—left the country in 2003 to study aeronautical engineering at a European university. He returned to northern Sri Lanka three months ago. His choice of subject became clear on March 26 when the Air Tigers used two light trainer aircraft to attack the Kattunayake airbase in Sri Lanka. Anthony is

NEW RECRUIT: Anthony (far left) with Prabhakaran believed to have worked on the aircraft's relatively sophisticated bomb release mechanism.

Prabhakaran's family moved abroad soon after peace talks with the Sri Lankan authorities began in 2001, possibly using the sea route to travel to a third country to emigrate to Europe. Indian intelligence officials call Anthony a latter day Prince Harry deployed in combat—of tremendous propaganda value, showing the Tiger supremo dedicating his own son to the cause, thus justifying more young recruits into the LTTE's 30-year-long struggle for a separate homeland. It could also be the supremo laying down a succession plan like any other South Asian political dynasty. "Prabhakaran knows that the movement will collapse if he is killed. So this is his Plan B," says an intelligence official.

The tragic Lankan conflict shows no signs of ending. It's now moving to Gen Next.

by Sandeep Unnithan

SIGNPOSTS

APPOINTED: Joint Secretary (Disarmament) **Hamid Ali Rao**, as India's permanent representative to the United Nation's Conference on Disarmament.



CONFERRED: On Bollywood actor **Dharmendra**, the Lifetime Achievement Award, by the

Indian Film Academy Awards in Sheffield, UK.

ARRESTED: Gangster **Santokben 'Godmother' Jadega**, by the Junagarh police, for allegedly sheltering two accused in the rape-cum-murder of two girls in Girnar hills.

ARRESTED: **Bharat Inder Singh Chahal**, media adviser to former Punjab chief minister Captain Amarinder Singh, in a case of attempt to murder and land-grabbing.

WON: By **Vijender**, the silver medal at the 24th Asian Boxing Championships in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, in the 75-kg category.

VIS-A-VIS **MAMATA BANERJEE** Trinamool Congress chief **versus** **JYOTI BASU** CPI(M) leader

If there is political will there'll be a way. Farmers' land in Singur must be returned. Our stand cannot change everyday.



Return of land to farmers is not possible. She must be aware of the legal complexities involved. Work has already begun there.

RAY

EPILOGUE: This, even after the so-called 'historic' meeting and pleasantries exchanged.